

FFY2026 Recommended Project Portfolio

Illinois State Water Survey — CHAMP Program

Prepared from analysis of FFY2020–FFY2024 funded portfolios and the draft (unfunded) FFY2025 portfolio. Context: FFY2025 NOFO was never issued due to federal budget/political constraints. This document recommends FFY2026 projects with the FFY2025 draft MASs as the primary baseline, updated for a 12-month period-of-performance shift and current project status.

Executive Summary

The ISWS CHAMP program enters FFY2026 with a one-year funding gap that has created five stalled near-final projects and a growing backlog of data development work awaiting production funding. The program has six effective FIRMs delivered across the FFY2020–FFY2022 cycle (Clay, Effingham, Stark, Bond, Richland, Cook/Kane PMR). Three more (Peoria, McHenry Nippersink, McDonough) are completing Post-Preliminary Processing under active FFY2024 awards and will issue effective FIRMs in 2025–2026 without additional production funding.

The FFY2026 portfolio must accomplish three things simultaneously:

1. **Unstall five near-complete projects** (Edwards, Wabash, Macoupin, and the upcoming Post-Preliminary MAS needs for Johnson and Bureau Counties).
2. **Advance the mid-pipeline investments** (Montgomery, Wayne, Kishwaukee Phase 6, Boone County) that are data-ready but have not yet entered the regulatory mapping process.
3. **Address the southern Illinois data development backlog** (Massac/Pope, Hamilton, White County, Rock Island) where KDP-2 data is aging without a production MAS.

Recommended FFY2026 portfolio total: approximately \$4,700,000–\$5,200,000 (core program + recommended Tier 3 items). If NOFO funding is constrained below \$4.5M, Tier 3 projects should be reduced in scope before cutting Tier 1 or Tier 2 items.

Period of Performance: All FRP MASs: 10/01/2026 – 09/30/2029 (3-year). PM, COMS, and LOMR SOWs: 10/01/2026 – 09/30/2028 (2-year).

Tier 1 — Highest Priority: Near Final FIRM

Projects that are 1–2 funded MASs away from effective FIRM issuance. These represent maximum return on prior investment. Every one of these was scoped in the unfunded FFY2025 draft and is ready to execute now.

Proposed ISWS_26-03: Edwards County, IL — Countywide DFIRM Post-Preliminary Processing

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_17-03 (Zone A DD) → ISWS_18-03 (Zone AE DD) → ISWS_23-06 (QR1 / Open House)
 - **Current Phase:** Post-Open House / Pre-Due Process. Preliminary FIRM (17 panels, 6 communities) distributed; CCO Meeting and Public Open House completed under ISWS_23-06. Project is **fully ready for Due Process to begin.**
 - **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - Task 24: Post-Preliminary Map Production Data Capture
 - Initiate 90-day statutory appeal period (KDP4)
 - Manage and resolve all appeals and technical comments
 - Produce final FIRM panels (AMP tool) — 17 panels, 6 communities
 - Process Letter of Final Determination (KDP5)
 - Distribute revalidation letters
 - Archive to TSDN/FEDD
 - Task 25: Develop Flood Risk Products (Flood Risk Database / FRD)
 - Includes FRP data upload to illinoisfloodmaps.org
 - **Estimated Budget:** \$111,820 (directly from FFY2025 draft, updated dates)
 - **Deliverable:** Effective FIRM for Edwards County
 - **Coordination Note:** **Must be funded and executed in tandem with ISWS_26-04 (Wabash County).** Bonpas Creek forms the shared county boundary; any appeal on that reach affects both projects.
 - **Rationale:** Eight years of investment across four MAS cycles. One funded MAS to an effective FIRM. Every month of delay since FFY2025 went unfunded costs community confidence and risks data currency.
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Proposed ISWS_26-04: Wabash County, IL — Countywide PMR Post-Preliminary Processing

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_17-08 (LAMP / Mt. Carmel Levee) → ISWS_18-03 (Zone A/AE DD) → ISWS_23-07 (QR1 / Open House)
- **Current Phase:** Post-Open House / Pre-Due Process. Preliminary FIRM (26 panels, 5 communities) distributed; CCO Meeting and Public Open House completed. Eight levee systems all proposed for Natural Valley mapping.
- **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - Task 24: Post-Preliminary Map Production (90-day appeal period, appeals resolution, final FIRM panels, LFD)
 - Task 25: Flood Risk Products (FRD)
- Levee notes documentation for all 8 Natural Valley levee systems
- **Estimated Budget:** \$119,050 (directly from FFY2025 draft, updated dates)
- **Deliverable:** Effective FIRM for Wabash County
- **Coordination Note:** Paired with ISWS_26-03 (Edwards County) due to Bonpas Creek shared boundary.

- **Rationale:** Project fully staged and waiting for Due Process funding for one year. Levee mapping paths (all Natural Valley) are already determined — no remaining ambiguity on levee treatment.
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Proposed ISWS_26-05: Macoupin County, IL — Countywide DFIRM Preliminary Release + Post-Preliminary Processing

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_19-05 (Zone A/AE DD) → ISWS_24-09 (QR1–QR3, 73 panels)
 - **Current Phase: QR3 complete** under ISWS_24-09. A fully-reviewed, production-ready Preliminary FIRM (73 panels, 28 communities, 7 watersheds) is complete but has NOT been distributed. This is the most urgent pipeline situation in the entire portfolio.
 - **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - Task 23: Distribute Preliminary Map Products (KDP3 / Preliminary Release)
 - Task 24: Post-Preliminary Map Production (CCO Meeting, Open House, 90-day appeal period, appeals resolution, Final FIRM production, LFD, revalidation letters)
 - Task 25: Flood Risk Products (FRD)
 - **Estimated Budget:** \$279,300 (directly from FFY2025 draft, updated dates)
 - **Deliverable:** Effective FIRM for Macoupin County (73 panels, 28 communities)
 - **Special Note:** Verify that no QR3 comments remain open under ISWS_24-09 before launching Task 23. If any issues were noted at QR3, resolve them first.
 - **Rationale:** A completed QR3 Preliminary FIRM sitting undistributed is the portfolio's most urgent unforced bottleneck. Community FPMs have been waiting since at least early 2025 to receive these materials. Every additional month of delay erodes trust and may require re-verification of community contacts and panel currency.
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Proposed ISWS_26-06: Johnson County, IL — Countywide DFIRM Post-Preliminary Processing

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_20-08 (Zone A/AE DD, Cache River 2D) → ISWS_24-06 (QR1 through Open House, active)
- **Current Phase:** Preliminary Map Production and Open House in progress under ISWS_24-06 (through 9/30/2027). Post-Preliminary MAS is needed for the step immediately following.
- **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - Task 24: Post-Preliminary Map Production (90-day appeal period, appeals resolution, Final FIRM, LFD, revalidation)
 - Task 25: Flood Risk Products (FRD)
- **Levee coordination:** Cache River/Karnak Levee and Reevesville Levee (both Non-Accredited, Natural Valley mapping path)
- **Estimated Budget:** ~\$130,000 (estimated; new MAS not in FFY2025 draft, sized by analogy with McHenry \$121,810 and McDonough \$118,150)
- **Deliverable:** Effective FIRM for Johnson County (32 panels, 8 communities)

- **Rationale:** Fund this now so it is ready to execute immediately after the ISWS_24-06 Open House milestone completes in 2026–2027. Funding gap between ISWS_24-06 and the Post-Preliminary phase must be avoided.
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Proposed ISWS_26-07: Bureau County, IL — Countywide PMR Post-Preliminary Processing

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_20-07 (Zone A/AE DD, Green River, Illinois River) → ISWS_24-07 (QR1 through Open House, active)
 - **Current Phase:** Preliminary Map Production and Open House in progress under ISWS_24-07 (through 9/30/2027). Post-Preliminary MAS needed for the next step.
 - **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - Task 24: Post-Preliminary Map Production (90-day appeal period, appeals resolution, Final FIRM, LFD, revalidation)
 - Task 25: Flood Risk Products (FRD)
 - Tiskilwa Levee coordination: both Tiskilwa levee systems moving from expired PAL to "Not Accredited" — confirm all NLD documentation is current before Due Process initiates
 - **Estimated Budget:** ~\$180,000 (estimated; larger project, 73 panels, sized above Peoria \$135,240 and McHenry \$121,810)
 - **Deliverable:** Effective FIRM for Bureau County (73 panels, 26 communities)
 - **Rationale:** Same logic as Johnson County — fund the Post-Preliminary MAS now to eliminate any gap when ISWS_24-07 Open House milestone completes.
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Proposed ISWS_26-08: Peoria County, IL — Flood Risk Products Supplement

- **Prior Funded Work:** 5 MAS generations (ISWS11-16, 18-04, 20-13, 21-09) for data development → ISWS_23-03 (Open House) → ISWS_24-03 (Post-Preliminary, terminal, active)
 - **Current Phase:** Post-Preliminary Processing in progress under ISWS_24-03; effective FIRM anticipated 2025–2026.
 - **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:** Develop Flood Risk Database (FRD) per SID 417 specifications; upload FRP content to illinoisfloodmaps.org. No new mapping — supplement only.
 - **Estimated Budget:** \$40,290 (directly from FFY2025 draft ISWS_25-03)
 - **Deliverable:** Flood Risk Database for Peoria County
 - **Dependency:** ISWS_24-03 must complete the effective FIRM first. Confirm timeline before launching this MAS.
 - **Rationale:** Completes the risk communication deliverables for a 20-year program investment. Small, low-risk addition.
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Proposed ISWS_26-09: McHenry County, IL — Flood Risk Products Supplement (Nippersink PMR)

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_15-01 → ISWS_19-09 → ISWS_23-04 (Open House) → ISWS_24-04 (Post-Preliminary, terminal, active)
 - **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:** Flood Risk Database (FRD); FRP content on illinoisfloodmaps.org.
 - **Estimated Budget:** \$35,090 (directly from FFY2025 draft ISWS_25-04)
 - **Deliverable:** Flood Risk Database for McHenry County Nippersink PMR panels
 - **Dependency:** ISWS_24-04 must complete effective FIRM first.
 - **Rationale:** Completes risk communication for a 10-year mapping investment.
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Proposed ISWS_26-10: McDonough County, IL — Flood Risk Products Supplement

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_19-04 → ISWS_23-05 (Open House) → ISWS_24-05 (Post-Preliminary, terminal, active)
 - **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:** Flood Risk Database (FRD); FRP content on illinoisfloodmaps.org.
 - **Estimated Budget:** \$35,090 (directly from FFY2025 draft ISWS_25-05)
 - **Deliverable:** Flood Risk Database for McDonough County
 - **Dependency:** ISWS_24-05 must complete effective FIRM first.
 - **Rationale:** Same as above. Completes risk communication deliverables.
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Tier 2 — Major Continuations: Data Development → Preliminary

Projects that have completed data development (or will complete it under active FFY2024 awards) and are ready to enter the regulatory mapping process. The Kishwaukee watershed is the single most important investment in this tier.

Proposed ISWS_26-11: Kishwaukee HUC8 Watershed — Data Development Phase 6 (Final DD Phase)

- **Prior Funded Work:** Discovery (ISWS_17-02) → Phase 1 survey (ISWS_20-12) → Phase 2 mainstem H&H (ISWS_21-12) → Phase 3 survey DeKalb/McHenry (ISWS_22-09) → Phase 4 H&H Winnebago/Boone/Ogle (ISWS_23-08, active) → Phase 5 tributaries DeKalb/Kane/McHenry (ISWS_24-08, active)
- **Current Phase:** Phases 4 and 5 actively executing under FFY2023 and FFY2024 awards. Phase 6 is the **explicitly described "final data development phase"** before Preliminary mapping begins.
- **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - New Zone A and Zone AE studies for ~195 miles of streams in Ogle, DeKalb, Kane, and McHenry Counties
 - 99 mi updated effective Zone A / 2D modeling; 67 mi updated Zone AE; 19 mi new unmapped Zone A; 10 mi new detailed Zone AE

- Hydrology: HEC-HMS, USGS Regression, Bulletin 17C, and/or 2D Rain on Mesh
- Hydraulics: 1D and 2D HEC-RAS
- Draft FIRM Database production (outputs to QR1-ready database)
- Community engagement: PICC Meeting, Flood Risk Review Meeting, Resilience Meeting
- SID 620/621 regulatory notifications
- Deliverables to MIP
- **Estimated Budget:** \$1,414,000 (directly from FFY2025 draft ISWS_25-11)
- **Study Miles:** 195 total
- **Deliverable:** Completed data development + Draft FIRM Database for Ogle, DeKalb, Kane, McHenry County portions of Kishwaukee HUC8
- **Contractor Note:** TBD — procurement must begin immediately upon NOFO award. Competitive procurement typically takes 3–6 months.
- **FFY2027 Link:** Phase 6 completion unlocks Preliminary DFIRM MASs for DeKalb County, Kane County, McHenry County, and/or Ogle County (likely as two or three separate county-level PMR production MASs).
- **Rationale:** Eight grant years of watershed investment will be stranded without Phase 6. Phase 6 is the keystone that converts data into regulatory products. Serves major Northern Illinois suburban communities (DeKalb, Sycamore, Woodstock, Crystal Lake, Elgin, Marengo, Huntley, Algonquin, and more).

Proposed ISWS_26-12: Boone County, IL — Data Development (Lower Rock Watershed)

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_23-08 (Kishwaukee Phase 4 addressed portions of Boone County in the Kishwaukee HUC8)
- **Current Phase:** Lower Rock watershed portion of Boone County not covered by the Kishwaukee HUC8 study. This MAS fills the gap to enable a complete countywide Boone County DFIRM.
- **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - New Zone A and Zone AE studies for 40.5 miles of streams (Lower Rock watershed, Boone County)
 - 5.5 mi updated Zone A; 11.4 mi updated Zone AE; 23.6 mi new unmapped Zone A
 - Hydrology: HEC-HMS + USGS Regression Equations
 - Hydraulics: 1D HEC-RAS
 - Community engagement: PICC Meeting, Flood Risk Review
 - SID 620/621 notifications
 - Draft FIRM Database
- **Estimated Budget:** \$329,000 (directly from FFY2025 draft ISWS_25-12)
- **Study Miles:** 40.5 total
- **Deliverable:** Data development + Draft FIRM Database for Boone County (Lower Rock watershed)
- **Coordination Note:** Must be coordinated closely with Kishwaukee Phase 6 (ISWS_26-11) since both feed the future Boone County countywide DFIRM production MAS.
- **Rationale:** Without this MAS, the Boone County countywide DFIRM cannot be completed regardless of Kishwaukee Phase 6 progress. City of Loves Park and Village of Caledonia are the affected communities.

Proposed ISWS_26-13: Montgomery County, IL — Countywide DFIRM QR1–QR3

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_21-06 (Zone A data development, 261 miles, 5 reservoirs, FFY2021)
 - **Current Phase:** Data development complete since ~2022. Draft FFY2025 MAS scoped QR1–QR3 production (not including distribution).
 - **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - Task 20: Draft FIRM Database Data Capture (QR1, DVT validation)
 - Task 21: Preliminary Map Products Data Capture (QR2/QR3)
 - Produce Preliminary FIRM panels for countywide Montgomery County (estimated ~40–50 panels)
 - Produce Preliminary FIS Report
 - Prepare Preliminary Issuance Letters and SOMAs
 - *(Distribution, CCO meeting, Open House, and Post-Preliminary deferred to a subsequent MAS)*
 - **Estimated Budget:** \$207,380 (directly from FFY2025 draft ISWS_25-09)
 - **Deliverable:** QR3-ready Preliminary FIRM for Montgomery County
 - **FFY2027 Link:** Follow-on MAS for Distribution + Post-Preliminary (~\$250K estimate).
 - **Rationale:** Zone A data development has been complete for 4+ years. Every year of delay increases the risk that base map data (IDOT aerials) and topographic information become outdated. Advancing to QR3 puts this project firmly on the path to an effective FIRM within 2–3 years.
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Proposed ISWS_26-14: Wayne County, IL — Countywide DFIRM QR1–QR3

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_17-03 (Little Wabash H&H, eastern Wayne County) → ISWS_20-11 (Skillet Fork H&H, western Wayne County)
 - **Current Phase:** Both halves of Wayne County have completed data development. Draft FFY2025 MAS scoped QR1–QR3 production combining both datasets into a unified countywide DFIRM.
 - **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - Task 20: Draft FIRM Database Data Capture (QR1, DVT validation) — incorporates both Skillet Fork and Little Wabash datasets
 - Task 21: Preliminary Map Products Data Capture (QR2/QR3)
 - Produce unified countywide Preliminary FIRM panels + Preliminary FIS Report
 - Prepare Preliminary Issuance Letters and SOMAs
 - Levee notes documentation for NLD-listed levees in Wayne County
 - *(Distribution, CCO, Open House, and Post-Preliminary deferred to follow-on MAS)*
 - **Estimated Budget:** \$201,980 (directly from FFY2025 draft ISWS_25-10)
 - **Deliverable:** QR3-ready Preliminary FIRM for Wayne County (combined countywide)
 - **FFY2027 Link:** Follow-on MAS for Distribution + Post-Preliminary (~\$200K estimate).
 - **Rationale:** Unifies two separate data development investments (FFY2017 and FFY2020) into a single countywide product. Wayne County communities have been waiting for updated flood maps since the Little Wabash FRR in early 2020.
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Tier 3 — New Starts or Overdue Production MASs

Projects where new data development, first DFIRM production, or long-delayed production is warranted. These represent important but lower-urgency investments. If FFY2026 funding is constrained, begin with the items most proximate to current data development completion.

Proposed ISWS_26-15: Saline HUC8 (Gallatin County) — Data Development Phase 1

- **Prior Funded Work:** None (new watershed engagement)
 - **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - 2D Rain on Mesh modeling for Gallatin County Saline HUC8 streams (171 miles)
 - Ohio River floodplain redelineation through Gallatin County
 - PICC meeting; SID 620 distribution
 - Internal model review (explicit partial phase — delineations and FRR deferred to Phase 2)
 - **Estimated Budget:** \$168,000 (directly from FFY2025 draft ISWS_25-13)
 - **Study Miles:** 171 total (104 mi updated ZA + 67 mi new unmapped ZA)
 - **Deliverable:** 2D models and Ohio River redelineation work products; PICC documentation
 - **Communities:** Gallatin County, Shawneetown, Equality, Junction, New Haven, Old Shawneetown, Omaha, Ridgeway
 - **Rationale:** New watershed initiation. Establishes the foundation for a Gallatin County DFIRM. Lower priority than projects with existing multi-year investment.
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Proposed ISWS_26-16: Rock Island County, IL — Mississippi River PMR Preliminary Production

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_17-06 (data dev) → ISWS_20-05 (East Moline levee engagement) → ISWS_21-02 (QR1 FIRM Database, 48 panels, 7 levee areas)
- **Current Phase:** QR1 FIRM Database completed under ISWS_21-02 (~2022–2023). No Preliminary production MAS funded in 4+ years.
- **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**
 - Verify data currency of QR1 database (may require minor updates given elapsed time)
 - Task 21–22: Preliminary Map Products production (QR2/QR3, 48 panels)
 - Task 23: Distribute Preliminary products
 - CCO Meeting + Public Open House
 - Advance levee PAL/accreditation status discussions with FEMA R5 RSC for all 7 levee areas
 - *(Post-Preliminary deferred to follow-on MAS)*
- **Estimated Budget:** ~\$450,000 (estimated; 48 panels, 7 complex levee areas — higher than typical preliminary production; sized above Bureau at \$239K)
- **Deliverable:** Preliminary FIRM for Rock Island County (48 panels); Open House completed

- **Levee Risk Note:** Seven levee areas (Rock Island City, Arsenal, East Moline, Milan West/Big Island, Milan East, Milan South Slough, Meredosia-RI portion) require PAL/accreditation determination before Due Process can proceed. Engage FEMA R5 RSC Levee Lead early.
- **FFY2027 Link:** Post-Preliminary Processing MAS after Open House (~\$250–300K).
- **Rationale:** QR1 data is aging — a 48-panel PMR with levee complexity takes years to complete and further delay risks data becoming outdated. The East Moline 2D levee model was specifically funded to support this production phase.

Proposed ISWS_26-17: Massac County + Pope County, IL — Countywide DFIRM Production (Joint)

- **Prior Funded Work (Massac):** ISWS_20-09 (Zone A/AE DD, Ohio River re-del., Massac Creek AE, Brookport/Reevesville levees)
- **Prior Funded Work (Pope):** ISWS_20-10 (Zone A DD, Ohio River re-del., Golconda/Reevesville levees, KY coordination)
- **Current Phase:** Both counties at KDP-2 since FFY2020 — data development 6 years old.
- **Proposed FFY2026 Scope (Joint MAS):**
 - Task 20: Draft FIRM Database for both Massac and Pope Counties
 - Task 21: Preliminary Map Products (QR1–QR3) for both counties
 - Task 23: Distribute Preliminary products
 - CCO and Open House for each county
 - Confirm Kentucky Division of Water FIRM coordination is current
 - Verify datum conversion documentation (NGVD29→NAVD88) is still valid
 - *(Post-Preliminary deferred to follow-on MAS)*
- **Estimated Budget:** ~\$450,000 (joint MAS covering both counties; sized as two ~\$225K production MASs consolidated)
- **Deliverable:** Preliminary FIRMs for Massac County and Pope County
- **Efficiency Note:** These counties share Ohio River boundary conditions, Reevesville Levee System, and Kentucky FIRM coordination. A joint production MAS is more efficient than two separate MASs.
- **Rationale:** Six-year-old data development investment will degrade further every year it goes unused. The Ohio River redelineation was state-of-the-art in 2020; its currency should be verified.

Proposed ISWS_26-18: Kaskaskia Watershed — H&H Data Development (Fayette / Shelby / Washington Counties)

- **Prior Funded Work:** ISWS_22-08 (USACE model review + 2D watershed scoping) → ISWS_23-02 (COMS strategic planning) → ISWS_23-14 (survey data, active through ~Sept 2025)
- **Current Phase:** Survey will complete by September 2025 under ISWS_23-14. The 2D watershed scoping models and community prioritization report are complete. The next step is H&H data development using the survey data.
- **Proposed FFY2026 Scope:**

- Full hydrologic and hydraulic data development for highest-priority Kaskaskia sub-reaches in Shelby, Fayette, and/or Washington Counties (specific reaches to be selected per FFY2023 COMS community prioritization output)
 - USACE Kaskaskia River model enhancement/repurposing for FEMA regulatory standards (building on ISWS_22-08 review)
 - 1D and/or 2D modeling per scoping recommendations
 - KDP-2 deliverable package
 - **Estimated Budget:** ~\$800,000 (estimated; complex multi-county watershed with USACE model integration)
 - **Deliverable:** KDP-2 H&H data development for priority Kaskaskia sub-reaches
 - **Rationale:** Survey investment from ISWS_23-14 (\$200K) becomes valuable only when H&H data development begins. Without this MAS, the Kaskaskia pipeline stalls permanently at the survey stage.
 - **Optional Scope Reduction:** If FFY2026 funding is tight, reduce scope to Fayette County only (~\$350–400K) and defer Shelby/Washington to FFY2027.
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Recurring / Administrative SOWs

Proposed ISWS_26-01: Program Management (PM) SOW

- **Scope:** Joint State Business Plan with IDNR/OWR; Global Program Management for all FFY2026 FRP mapping activities; CNMS database updates; Programmatic QA/QC Plan; staff CFM/PE certification maintenance. Global Outreach and Mentoring tasks under companion COMS SOW; if COMS is not funded, add ~\$40K to PM budget for those tasks.
 - **Period:** 10/01/2026 – 09/30/2028
 - **Estimated Budget:** \$100,000
 - **Rationale:** Required annual overhead for CTP program maintenance. Business Plan feeds future NOFO eligibility.
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Proposed ISWS_26-02: Community Outreach and Mitigation Strategies (COMS) SOW

- **Scope:** COMS Engagement Plan; Strategic Planning for community outreach (focus on projects entering Due Process and communities receiving new maps — Edwards, Wabash, Macoupin, and potentially Montgomery/Wayne); illinoisfloodmaps.org maintenance and update; NFIP 101, MT-2/LOMR training events; mitigation planning technical assistance; CTP Mentoring.
 - **Period:** 10/01/2026 – 09/30/2028
 - **Estimated Budget:** \$200,000
 - **Rationale:** Required for program-wide community engagement. Especially important in FFY2026 given multiple counties simultaneously entering Due Process and receiving new Preliminary FIRMs.
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Proposed ISWS_26-LOMR: LOMR Review Partners — Statewide Illinois

- **Scope:** Continue ISWS's assumption of MT-2 CLOMR/LOMR review responsibility for all of Illinois. Process initiation through post-processing; FEMA retains final determination authority. Target: 87%+ of cases within 140 days. Estimated ~23 cases in process per quarter. Allow for carryover cases from lapsed FFY2025 gap.
- **Period:** 10/01/2026 – 09/30/2028
- **Estimated Budget:** \$345,000
- **Rationale:** Ongoing regulatory service. LOMR case volume is independent of the NOFO gap — cases continue to accumulate. A 12-month funding gap may have created a backlog; budget may need adjustment upward.

Projects NOT Recommended for FFY2026

Project / County	Reason Not Recommended
Clay County, Effingham County	✓ Effective FIRM issued — complete
Stark County, Bond County, Richland County	✓ Effective FIRM issued — complete
Cook/Kane PMR (Poplar/Spring Creek)	✓ Effective FIRM issued — complete
Hamilton County (DFIRM production)	Appropriate for FFY2026 if budget allows, but lower priority than listed Tier 3 items; data development complete since FFY2021. Queue for FFY2027 if budget constrained.
White County (preliminary production)	Low complexity but low urgency; queue for FFY2027.
Turtle Creek (IL/WI bi-state)	Project stalled at post-FRR since FFY2020; verify IDNR-OWR and WDNR model acceptance status before scoping Preliminary MAS.
Alexander/Pulaski (preliminary production)	Data development active under ISWS_23-09 through 9/30/2026; Cairo Vicinity levee mapping path unresolved — too early for production funding until the levee issue is resolved and KDP-2 is complete.
Embarras River (new MAS)	ISWS_23-10 and ISWS_24-10 both actively executing; no new Embarras MAS warranted in FFY2026.
Kaskaskia survey (new)	Survey underway under ISWS_23-14. No new survey MAS needed.
Henry / Whiteside PMR preliminary	ISWS_23-12 and ISWS_23-13 still active through 9/30/2026. Preliminary production MASs are appropriate for FFY2027 after those data development efforts complete.
Wabash/Mid-Lower River mainstem	ISWS_23-11 coordination active. Individual county projects (Edwards, Wabash County) are addressed in Tier 1. No new mainstem MAS warranted.

FFY2026 Budget Summary

Tier	# Projects	Est. Budget
Tier 1 — Near Final FIRM	8	\$930,730
— Edwards County Post-Prelim (26-03)	1	\$111,820
— Wabash County Post-Prelim (26-04)	1	\$119,050
— Macoupin County Prelim Release + Post-Prelim (26-05)	1	\$279,300
— Johnson County Post-Prelim (26-06)	1	\$130,000
— Bureau County Post-Prelim (26-07)	1	\$180,000
— Peoria FRP supplement (26-08)	1	\$40,290
— McHenry FRP supplement (26-09)	1	\$35,090
— McDonough FRP supplement (26-10)	1	\$35,090
Tier 2 — Mid-Pipeline Continuations	4	\$2,152,360
— Kishwaukee Phase 6 (26-11)	1	\$1,414,000
— Boone County DD (26-12)	1	\$329,000
— Montgomery County QR1–QR3 (26-13)	1	\$207,380
— Wayne County QR1–QR3 (26-14)	1	\$201,980
Tier 3 — New Starts / Overdue Production	4	\$1,868,000
— Saline HUC8/Gallatin DD Phase 1 (26-15)	1	\$168,000
— Rock Island PMR Preliminary (26-16)	1	\$450,000
— Massac/Pope DFIRM Production (joint, 26-17)	1	\$450,000
— Kaskaskia H&H Data Development (26-18)	1	\$800,000
Administrative / Recurring	3	\$645,000
— PM SOW (26-01)	1	\$100,000
— COMS SOW (26-02)	1	\$200,000
— LOMR Review (26-LOMR)	1	\$345,000
TOTAL (Full Portfolio)	19	\$5,596,090

Budget Scenarios

Scenario	Included Items	Est. Total
Minimum viable (Tier 1 + Tier 2 core + Admin)	26-01 through 26-14 + LOMR	~\$3,728,090

Scenario	Included Items	Est. Total
Core recommended (+ Rock Island + Massac/Pope)	Above + 26-16 + 26-17	~\$4,628,090
Full portfolio (all tiers)	All 19 MASs	~\$5,596,090

If NOFO award total is between these scenarios, prioritize within Tier 3 in this order: Rock Island PMR (longest stall at QR1) → Massac/Pope joint DFIRM → Kaskaskia H&H → Saline HUC8.

Looking Ahead: FFY2027 Preview

If FFY2026 funds the recommended portfolio above, the following projects will be ready for FFY2027 funding:

Near-Term Effective FIRMs (FFY2027 completions):

- **Edwards County + Wabash County:** Both will complete Due Process and issue effective FIRMs during the FFY2026 period of performance (or shortly into FFY2027 depending on appeal resolution timing).
- **Macoupin County:** Preliminary distribution will be followed by Due Process; effective FIRM expected in FFY2027.
- **Johnson County + Bureau County:** Post-Preliminary MASs funded in FFY2026 will execute and both counties should issue effective FIRMs in FFY2027–2028.

FFY2027 New Production MASs Needed:

- **Montgomery County:** Preliminary Distribution + Post-Preliminary MAS (~\$250K)
- **Wayne County:** Preliminary Distribution + Post-Preliminary MAS (~\$200K)
- **Henry County + Whiteside County:** After ISWS_23-12 and ISWS_23-13 complete in 2026, a combined Preliminary production MAS is warranted (~\$350–450K)
- **Rock Island County:** Post-Preliminary MAS after Open House (~\$250–300K)
- **Massac/Pope Counties:** Post-Preliminary MAS after Open House (~\$200K)
- **Hamilton County:** DFIRM production MAS (QR1 through Open House) if not funded in FFY2026 (~\$200K)
- **White County:** Preliminary production MAS (~\$150K)

FFY2027 Continuing Data Development:

- **Kishwaukee:** Preliminary DFIRM MASs for 2–3 counties (DeKalb/Kane/McHenry or Ogle — funded after Phase 6 completes)
- **Boone County:** Countywide DFIRM production MAS combining Kishwaukee + Lower Rock datasets
- **Kaskaskia:** Phase 2 H&H (if Phase 1/FFY2026 completes sub-reaches on schedule)
- **Alexander/Pulaski:** Preliminary production MAS (after ISWS_23-09 KDP-2 complete and Cairo levee issue resolved)
- **Embarras River:** First-county DFIRM preliminary production (likely Jasper County, after ISWS_24-10 tributaries complete)
- **Saline HUC8/Gallatin:** Phase 2 data development (complete delineations, FRR)

FFY2027 Administrative:

- PM SOW renewal
 - COMS SOW renewal
 - LOMR Review continuation
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Implementation Notes

Immediate Actions (Pre-NOFO):

1. **Begin Kishwaukee Phase 6 contractor procurement planning** — competitive solicitation takes 3–6 months; planning can begin before NOFO award.
2. **Verify Macoupin County QR3 status** — confirm no open QR3 comments under ISWS_24-09 before the Task 23 (Distribution) MAS is scoped.
3. **Confirm Edwards/Wabash County MIP status** — verify preliminary distribution records and community contact currency; any lapsed FPM contacts should be refreshed before Due Process initiates.
4. **Resolve Cairo Vicinity levee mapping path** — for Alexander/Pulaski (ISWS_23-09); engage FEMA R5, USACE, and IDNR-OWR before FFY2027 preliminary production MAS is scoped.
5. **Confirm IDNR-OWR/WDNR acceptance of Turtle Creek model** — if model acceptance was confirmed after ISWS_20-06, a Preliminary/PPP MAS for Turtle Creek should be added to the FFY2027 queue.

CEJST/Equity Amendments:

All FFY2024 MASs received CEJST language amendment packages (24-02A through 24-10A) signed by Glenn Heistand on 05/28/2025 with FEMA countersignature pending. Ensure these amendments are fully executed before the FFY2024 performance periods close. Apply the same scope language standards (non-CEJST, non-equity-index) to all FFY2026 MAS documents from the outset.

Levee Coordination:

At least 6 active or upcoming projects involve non-accredited levees. Before FFY2026 Due Process phases begin (especially Edwards, Wabash, Johnson, Bureau), confirm levee mapping path is fully documented and agreed to by FEMA R5 RSC. Natural Valley mapping paths should be confirmed in writing.